

NCCA ENTERTAINMENT PRESENTS

They found the perfect match.
They just used the wrong names.

STANDBY

CONTEMPORARY ROMANTIC COMEDY / FEATURE FILM

Written by Kelly R. Tenney

LOGLINE

Love gets complicated when both people send a stand-in.

When a guarded Atlanta dating consultant secretly goes on first dates for anxious clients, she meets her match in an architect impersonating his equally nervous best friend. As the two proxies fall for each other under borrowed names, they risk their careers, their closest friendships, and the real romance forming between the clients they betrayed.

ATLANTA • MODERN DATING • BORROWED IDENTITIES

Two stand-ins fall for each other while their clients fall for the idea of each other.

01

PROXY DATES

A fresh engine for escalating romantic deception

02

DOUBLE ROMANCE

Two couples move toward love on opposite tracks

03

PUBLIC EXPOSURE

The scheme detonates at a glamorous BlindMatch gala

04

EMOTIONAL PAYOFF

The fantasy survives only when the performance ends

TONE & COMPARABLES

Sexy, sophisticated, fast-witted, emotionally honest

HITCH	Professionalized dating meets personal blind spots
SET IT UP	Contemporary rom-com momentum and workplace polish
THE TRUTH ABOUT CATS & DOGS	Attraction grows inside a borrowed identity
INSECURE	Specific Black professional life, intimacy, and humor

Positioning: elevated studio rom-com with sharp social satire and a warm, commercial finish

CHLOE MARSH

27 / FOUNDER OF STANDBY

She can read everyone in the room except herself.

PERSONALITY

Controlled, observant, dryly funny. She turns emotional risk into a system she can manage.

GOAL

Protect StandBy, prove her judgment, and keep love at a safe professional distance.

CONFLICT

Ben sees through the performance. Choosing him means admitting that control has become her disguise.





BEN WHITFIELD

29 / ARCHITECT

He designs honest spaces while living inside someone else's name.

PERSONALITY

Warm, quick, loyal. He improvises confidence for everyone except himself.

ARC

What begins as a favor becomes the first choice he makes for his own emotional life.

CONNECTION

Chloe challenges his charm. Their chemistry deepens when both stop performing their clients.

THE PEOPLE CAUGHT IN THE PERFORMANCE

Every supporting character pressures Chloe and Ben toward the truth from a different angle.

1

SADIE OKAFOR

Chloe’s brilliant best friend and first boundary crossed. Romantic anxiety hides fierce self-respect.

2

MARK

Ben’s numbers-first best friend. Socially anxious, unexpectedly tender, and capable of choosing honesty.

3

REGINA MARSH

Chloe’s formidable wedding-planner mother. She sees love as both feeling and public architecture.

4

RILEY

StandBy’s bold proxy dater. A glimpse of what happens when the service outruns Chloe’s control.

5

GREGORY & WALTER

Ben’s opposing father figures: one rewards ambition, the other demands integrity.

STORY IN THREE ACTS

ACT I

THE MATCH

Chloe takes Sadie’s first date. Ben takes Mark’s. The proxies recognize a rare spark and each decides to keep the truth off the table.

ACT II

THE PERFORMANCE

Secret dates become real intimacy. Meanwhile, Sadie and Mark connect by text. Chloe and Ben’s careers rise as their friendships begin to fracture.

ACT III

THE REVEAL

At the BlindMatch gala, every identity collides. Public fallout forces both couples to decide whether trust can survive the truth.

VISUAL LANGUAGE

Atlanta after dark, where romance feels polished and every reflection suggests a second self.

BLUE-HOUR ATLANTA

SPEAKEASY AMBER

GLASS REFLECTIONS

APP WAVEFORMS

TAILORED ROMANCE

PUBLIC SPECTACLE



Texture: paper grain, brushed brass, velvet shadow, rain on glass

CASTING WISHLIST

Aspirational casting direction. No attachments implied.

RD

RYAN DESTINY

CHLOE MARSH

LL

LUCIEN LAVISCOUNT

BEN WHITFIELD

CJ

COCO JONES

SADIE OKAFOR

TW

TYLER JAMES WILLIAMS

MARK

RH

REGINA HALL

REGINA MARSH

Casting goal: magnetic leads with comic timing, dramatic weight, and genuine adult chemistry

WHY STANDBY FITS BET+

A commercial romance centered on Black professional life, friendship, and adult emotional stakes.

- ✓ Black professionals drive the romance rather than orbiting it.
- ✓ Atlanta supplies recognizable culture, aspiration, and production texture.
- ✓ The high-concept premise lands in a sentence and cuts cleanly into a trailer.
- ✓ The story balances romance with friendship, career, and family consequences.
- ✓ A contained feature scale supports premium locations without spectacle-level cost.
- ✓ The StandBy business can generate future clients, conflicts, and companion stories.

SECONDARY POSITIONING

Netflix / Amazon MGM / Tubi / OWN

PACKAGE & NEXT STEPS

AVAILABLE NOW

- ✓ Feature screenplay
- ✓ Pitch deck
- ✓ 16:9 key art
- ✓ Casting wishlist
- ✓ Buyer positioning

NEXT STEPS

01 **LOCK POLISH**

Complete final logic and dialogue pass

02 **PACKAGE**

Confirm director and casting targets

03 **ATTACH**

Approach lead talent and producing partners

04 **TAKE OUT**

Schedule targeted buyer meetings